

Extending the *Time Elements Character Core Set* sprite style with expansion content

Thank you for buying the *Time Elements: Character Expansion 1* asset pack. This asset pack is intended to serve as an expansion to the [Time Elements Character Core Set](#).

Requirements

This guide assumes that you own the *Character Core Set*, and that you own and are intending to use the pixel art character creation program [Top Down Sprite Maker](#) – which is the premium generator supported by this asset pack – to customize your characters and export your sprite sheets.

If not, you can find the art assets and the default generator program in the ZIP that is listed as the primary download option for this expansion where you purchased it.

Instructions

Follow these steps to extend the *Core Character Set* sprite style with the assets from this expansion. There is a [tutorial available on YouTube](#) if you would prefer to follow along.

1 – Locate sprite style ZIP file

Open a second **file manager**^a window and locate your *Time Elements* sprite style ZIP file on your computer. It is named `elements_tdsm_style.zip` by default. If you cannot find it, navigate to the marketplace where you purchased the *Time Elements Character Core Set* and select the download file with the suffix `_tdsm.zip`. Inside this initial ZIP file, you will find the sprite style ZIP file and a README with instructions for how to upload the sprite style to *Top Down Sprite Maker*.

^a – The file manager is File Explorer if you are on Windows and Finder if you are on macOS. If you are using a different operating system, this merely refers to the program you use to navigate folders and files on your computer.

2 – Extract sprite style ZIP contents to new folder

Once you have located your sprite style ZIP file, unzip/extract its contents to a folder of your choice on your computer. Once you have, this new folder should contain the file `manifest.tds`, and the subfolders `csv` and `originals`.

3 – Copy/cut the contents of `art-additions` subfolders into matching `originals` subfolders

In your initial file manager window, navigate into the `art-additions` folder found next to this README file. Copy/cut and paste all the contents of each of the subfolders of `art-additions` into the matching subfolder of `originals` in the unzipped contents of the sprite style in your second file manager window.

For example, all the PNG files in `art-additions/head` should be copied/cut and pasted into `originals/head`.

4 – Append contents of `csv-additions` files to matching layer CSV files

In your initial file manager window, navigate into the `csv-additions` folder. Copy the entire line of text of each `add_to_[layer].csv` file and append it to the end of the corresponding `[layer].csv` file found in the subfolder `csv` of the unzipped sprite style contents.

For example, if the file `head.csv` initially had the contents `head1, head2, head3`, and the file `add_to_head.csv` has the contents `, head4, head5`, then `head.csv` should now say `head1, head2, head3, head4, head5`.

Be sure to include the initial comma in the `add_to_[layer].csv` file. Ensure that the added contents are on the same line as the initial contents, with no spaces in between. The file should consist of two lines; the second line should be blank.

5 – Repackage your sprite styles with changes

Now that you have added the expansion's contents to `originals` and their metadata to `csv`, you can re-zip the sprite style. In your file manager, select `manifest.tds`, along with the `csv` and `originals` folders. With all three selected, right-click one of them and compress them to a ZIP file^b. You can call this ZIP file whatever you want as long as it has the `.zip` file extension.

^b – On Windows, you can ZIP files by selecting `Send to > Compressed (zipped) folder`. On macOS, simply select `Compress`.

This is your updated sprite style. You can upload it to *Top Down Sprite Maker* with the  (+) icon on the customization page past the main menu.

Note that you can continue to extend this sprite style with additional *Time Elements* expansions that you own by following the same series of steps, treating your expanded sprite style as the "initial" sprite style.

Help

If you need additional help or encounter a technical issue, please email the developer of *Top Down Sprite Maker* at jordanbunkework@gmail.com.